



FLAT CHAT NEWSLETTER
AUSTIN-HEALEY OWNERS CLUB (NSW) INC
ABN: 87 630 303 136

Mildura Meander

by Gordon Lynas - Chief Meanderer



Photos Lyn Fitzpatrick (LF) & Gordon Lynas (GL)

We were meant to be going a meandering way to Mildura for the Victorian AHOC's Mini-Rally. With a little over a month to go the dreaded 'C' struck and Mildura was off-limits to everyone from elsewhere. However, the brave Meanderers weren't going to let a little thing like the object of the trip disappearing in a cloud of disinfectant to prevent them from meandering. Two cars set off from northern NSW to meet with most of the rest of us at Sydney. These were Ray Hick and Fay Bryant's car and Adrian and Marita Joseph's. They are members of the AHOC of Queensland. Ray had rung me a few weeks before the run enquiring if there was a NSW 'convoy' organised for the trip to Mildura for the Mini-Rally. They all live on the NSW side of the Queensland border and so are members of their closest club, being that of Queensland. However, with the Queensland border being closed there would not be any Queensland domiciled Austin-Healeys going to Mildura. Ray, Fay, Marita and Adrian had

previously joined us at Inverell and Dorrigo a couple of years ago, so were known to quite a few of the Charlie's Run regulars. Others may know them from past National Rallies. Naturally, we welcomed them to the Meander.

There ought to have been four Austin-Healeys in convoy from St Ives, but the Joseph's was delayed for a new screen, the Sherman's was delayed by a flat battery, and the Hick Healey was swapped for a more waterproof Corvette at the last moment. So, Henrietta convoyed herself, with a Corvette escort, as far as Sutton Forrest where we were joined eventually by the Sherman, Fitzpatrick and French Austin-Healeys. Now we were four Austin-Healeys and a Corvette. I like to think the five of us made a nice little parade down the Hume Highway to Jugiong. The weather could have been better, but it could also have been a lot worse! We were accompanied by occasional showers past Goulburn and Yass and then the sun emerged, and we all warmed up.

Cont' page 14

VOL. 8 ISSUE #12
December 2021

COMING EVENTS

December

2nd Christmas Party at
Strathfield Golf Club
8th Committee Meeting

January

Not much

February

4th Monthly Meeting
6-19th Tassie Tour
9th Committee Meeting
27th Presentation Day

IN THIS ISSUE

P1.. Mildura Meander
P2..President's Message/C'itee
P3...Editorial
P4... Minutes & Reports
P11 .. Central Coast Workshop
P12 ... Engine Rebuild
P17 Rear Indicators
P19 ... Who Will Save It?
P20 .. Photos of Interest
P22... Gearbox Oil Change
P23 ... Importing Challengers
P25 Healey - DeLorean
P26... Free To A Good Home



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PO Box 6494
North Ryde NSW 2113

EMAIL: enquiries@austinhealeynsw.com.au
WEB: www.austinhealeynsw.com.au
FB: www.facebook.com/groups/681723625314952/

Our monthly meetings are held at Strathfield Golf Club, 52 Weeroona Rd, Strathfield NSW 2135 on the 1st Thursday of each month commencing at 7.30pm.

Members and guests are welcome to join us for dinner in the bistro from 5.30pm.



PRESIDENT'S MESSAGE

As we near the end of 2021 we will soon be having our club Christmas dinner and thankfully, we are back to holding meetings 'in the flesh', rather than on Zoom. Long may we be able to continue! The other thing that happens at each year end is that your committee retires and is replaced by the new committee elected at the November AGM. I'd like to express my thanks to the outgoing committee for all the effort that went into keeping the club functioning despite the pandemic. Particular thanks goes to Bruce Ewan who has had the most frustrating year, organising events only to see them cancelled as Covid restrictions bit. I do hope he has a more rewarding 2022 when hopefully we will actually get out and about in our cars.

Those of you who attended the AGM will know that the incoming committee is almost identical to the outgoing one, with the exception that Jim Phillips replaces Geoff Smith as vice-president, thus maintaining the Central Coast

influence on the committee and Neville Stirton has passed on the Technical Officer reigns to Greg Strange. Thinking about the long term dedication of some of the committee members brings Christine Lyttle and Patrick Quinn instantly to mind. I might be wrong, but I think Christine has been our membership secretary since around 2005 and a committee member since the late 1970s, while Patrick has been compiling our marque vehicle register for over 35 years as well as administering our Historic Vehicle registration system for longer. Just to stay busy, he has also been editing *Flat Chat* for more than a decade, and the *Australian Austin-Healey* magazine since its inception in 2014. The Club is able to prosper in part because of such dedication and I think they deserve recognition and our very sincere thanks.

Elsewhere in this *Flat Chat* you can read about the Mildura Meander which was our first 'trip away' in quite a long time. This run saw a smaller group than usual head off



Gordon Lynas – 0403 198 343 – gordonl@aussiebb.com.au

for Swan Hill and back, Mildura being closed. We visited some old haunts and found a nice new one at Jugiong and all of the cars behaved themselves. Not only that, but apart from the first and last days, we managed to travel in sunshine and stayed mostly dry, as you can see from the photographs.

Happy Healeying

Gordon

COMMITTEE LIST - 2021

Club Patron—Ross Bond

President - Gordon Lynas
4 Wanari Road
Terrey Hills NSW 2084
0403 198 343
gordonl@aussiebb.com.au

Vice-President - Geoff Smith
0458 777 339
m.gpsmith@bigpond.com

Secretary - Julie Lee
0421 598 755
hedli@tpg.com.au

Treasurer - John Sherman
0419 976 844
johnsher42@gmail.com

Social Secretary - Bruce Ewan
0432 096 493
bruce.ewan1@gmail.com

Editor - Patrick Quinn
"Wongaburra"
116 Warks Hill Rd.,
Kurrajong Heights 2758
(02) 4567 7380
0417 673 065
p_cquinn@tpg.com.au

Historian - Joe Armour
0419 233 099
joea6@bigpond.com

Membership Secretary - Christine Lyttle
0410 201 373
membership@austinhealeynsw.com.au

Regalia - Colin Rule
0467 563 523
coolibahconvertible@bigpond.com

Technical Officer - Neville Stirton
0414 472 877
stirton@bigpond.net.au

Club Registrar - Patrick Quinn
(Inc Conditional Registration)
Please send all Conditional Registration documents to Patrick's postal address at left

Public Relations - Ross Penman
0408 465 547
penmans@bigpond.com

Webmaster - Jim Phillips
0413 589 306
jpjimbeau@gmail.com

Public Officer - Alan Mitchell
PO Box 123
Marulan 2579
0412 898 656
mitchellaj@ozemail.com.au

Non-Committee Positions
CSCA Delegate - Colin Goldsmith

Librarian - Ron Strange

CMC Delegates - Ray Roberts
Ian Clayton

Welfare Officer - Pamela Ross 0408 201 226

Display Day Coordinators - Ross & Jenny Penman

Conditional Registration Inspectors - Neville Stirton
0414 472 877
Geoff Smith
0458 777 339

Assn of British Car Clubs Reps - Christine Lyttle

National Assn Delegates - Gordon Lynas & Jim Phillips

AHOC Life Members - Don Read, Warwick Sell, Joe Armour, Christine Lyttle, Patrick Quinn, Terry Bancroft, Ray Roberts and David Mould.

If you want to send something by post, the Club's address is:-

AHOC (NSW) Inc
PO Box 6494
North Ryde NSW 2113

It would be appreciated if there were no phone calls to committee members after 9:00 PM.

EXHAUST LEAKS



By Patrick Quinn
(02) 4567 7380
0417 673 065
p_quinn@tpg.com.au

Greetings and welcome to the December 2021 issue of the *Flat Chat Newsletter*.

There was movement at the station, for the word had passed around that it was safe to get out and enjoy our cars. You will see that in this issue of the *Flat Chat Newsletter*. We can only hope it continues, but with new Covid strains and everything that entails, who knows what tomorrow will bring?

The month not only saw a Central Coast workshop, but also the running of the Mildura Meander, which incidentally never got to its original destination due to Covid. So it's thanks to Col and Kerrie Rule for the report on the workshop and to Gordon Lynas for his report on the meandering. Thanks to Gordon for his article on rear indicators.

Wonderful that the engine has returned to Neil Janes' Mk1 BN7 and you can read his final instalment starting on page 12. Special thanks to Neil as this is his fourth instalment about the engine rebuild.

As a result of a chance conversation with new member Damien Carrick, he forwarded copies of documentation indicating what

he went through importing his BJ8 from the UK. Australian born Damien had actually owned his car for quite some years and found the hurdles that had to be jumped to be tall, but not quite insurmountable. Thanks to Damien and also thanks to Rick Neville in the US for allowing us to republish his article on what could have happened following the end of BMC making the Austin-Healey. There are lots more in this issue including all the important committee reports and two lots of minutes from the November meeting and the AGM. Aren't you lucky that these are there for you to read? Please do, as they provide you with information about your club.

It's pleasing to say that things are moving with the Quinn Austin-Healey and it's thanks to Neville Stirton who made the trek to the mountains so that the front chrome body strips are now installed. I had bought these years ago and they

come wrapped in a black plastic covering that was a little recalcitrant in not wanting to separate from the strips, but it all ended the way it was meant to be.

The boot lid has returned after being repainted, but it's not yet refitted. Also returned freshly repainted is the aluminium strip that separates the rear shroud from the rear seats. Most wouldn't know that part of the history of the car is that it's the first Austin-Healey fitted with the two rear jump seats. It was sent from the Donald Healey Motor Company to Jensen for the modifications and on completion I suspect the apprentice was given the job to cover the join with a strip of aluminium. It's pretty rough and ready!

Trust you enjoy this issue of the *Flat Chat Newsletter*, and yes there will be a January issue that will report on the forthcoming Christmas Party and whatever else you kind people wish to send me.





Minutes of the General Meeting

Thursday, 4 November 2021.

Commenced: 7:40pm.

Venue - Strathfield Golf Club

ATTENDEES

Refer attendance list.

VISITORS & NEW MEMBERS

Frank van den Berg was welcomed as a new member of the Club.

APOLOGIES

Glenn Barnes, Janice & Jeff Burton, Bruce Ewan, Mal French, Richard Horwood, Doug & Pamela Ross, Geoff Smith and John Wakeling.

APPROVAL OF MINUTES

Resolved that the minutes of the General Meeting held 7 October 2021, as published in the November 2021 issue of *Flat Chat*, be verified as a correct record of that meeting.

PRESIDENT'S REPORT

Gordon advised of the non-Committee appointments which had been approved at the October Committee meeting, and thanked those members for taking on the roles:

- Association of British Car Clubs Representative – Christine Lyttle
- CMC Delegate – Ray Roberts
- CSCA Delegate – Colin Goldsmith
- Welfare Officer – Pamela Ross
- Display Day Coordinators – Ross & Jenny Penman
- Conditional Registration Inspectors – Neville Stirton & Geoff Smith
- Librarian – Ronnie Strange
- National Association Representatives – Gordon Lynas & Jim Phillips

Although Pamela had agreed to continue as Welfare Officer, Gordon advised that she'd also said she would be happy to hand this over to someone who was able to regularly attend meetings. If anyone was interested, they could contact Pamela.

Gordon advised that his Swan Hill Meander (formerly the Mildura Meander!) was heading off the next day.

VICE-PRESIDENT'S REPORT

No report.

SECRETARY'S REPORT

Julie advised of snail mail received:

- The Australian Jaguar Driver – October

Electronic magazines and newsletters received:

- Healeys West (WA) – November
- Speed Read (MSA) – October
- Healey Torque (Qld) – November

Other emails received:

- Management Liability Insurance renewal
- A query about importing a BJ8 from Ireland
- Several from Vintage Car Hire looking for cars on particular dates, but they were generally very vague about the type of car wanted

TREASURER'S REPORT

John advised of the Club's funds as at 31 October 2021:

Debit card	\$301.93
Main Account	\$24,499.67
Cash Reserve	\$12,500.47
Charlie's Run	\$8,067.12
Term Deposit	\$78,945.63
Interest Earned	\$0.12

Receipts for the month included payments for the Christmas Party (38 people), several memberships and sale of a windscreen. Payments made were a deposit payment for the Christmas Party, plus flowers to the Sell family on the passing of founding and life member, Warwick Sell.

SOCIAL SECRETARY'S REPORT

No report

WELFARE OFFICER'S REPORT

No report

WEBMASTER'S REPORT

Jim reported that the RSVP function, which would enable members to accept invitations to events, was currently being tested.

MEMBERSHIP

Christine had one new member to report on – James Moffatt, who has a MK1 BT7.

EDITOR'S REPORT

Patrick advised that Flat Chat had been issued the previous evening, with no bounce backs.

**REGISTRAR**

Patrick reported that he'd had a flurry of new registrations in the last month, with an additional five cars.

HISTORIAN

No report

LIBRARIAN

Ronnie threatened to hand out big fines to Greg Strange and Julie Lee for having overdue library books!

**TECHNICAL OFFICER/CLUB EQUIPMENT/
SPARE PARTS**

Nothing to report.

PUBLIC RELATIONS REPORT

Nothing to report

CMC REPORT

No report

ASSOCIATION OF BRITISH CAR CLUBS

No report

CSCA REPORT

Colin provided a brief update on Supersprint activity.

Terry then took the opportunity to speak about Warwick Sell, who he had known very well for many years. Terry suggested that a memorial run could be organised for early in the new year.

REGALIA

Colin was back to his best with an audience to spruik to! A couple of items up for grabs included:

- car stickers
- a BJ8 sales brochure - \$15
- a half-scale model (no. 2 of 3) of a 45mm Weber carburettor – \$550 (no. 1 was in the Healey Museum in the Netherlands)

FOR SALE/WANTED

Neville Stirton advised that he had a couple of BJ8 projects for sale.

GENERAL BUSINESS

No general business was raised.

Meeting concluded at 8:20pm.

Austin Healey Owners Club (NSW) Inc Annual General Meeting

Minutes of the meeting held 4 November 2021 at Strathfield Golf Club, 52 Weeroona Road, Strathfield NSW 2135

Present – refer Club Point Score List for attendees

Gordon Lynas, President and Chair of the meeting, noting that there was a quorum, called the meeting to order at 8:25 pm, and welcomed all attendees.

The Chair advised that no proxies had been received for the meeting, but an apology had been received from Allan Whitehouse.

1. Minutes of the 2020 Annual General Meeting

Draft minutes of the 2020 AGM had been published in the December 2020 edition of Flat Chat, plus they had been included in the AGM Notice which had been sent to members on 19 October 2021.

RESOLVED that draft minutes of the Annual General Meeting held 5 November 2020 be approved.

2. Committee Report

The Committee's report had been included in the AGM Notice.

RESOLVED that the Committee's Report for 2020/21 be noted.

3. Financial Statements

The Club's financial statements had been included in the AGM Notice.

RESOLVED that the financial statements for the year ending 30 June 2021 be approved.

4. Election of Committee Members

The President handed the Chair to Colin Goldsmith to conduct the election of officeholders.

Colin thanked the outgoing Committee members, declared all positions vacant, then conducted the election of Committee members.



Completed nominations had been received by the due date for the following roles, so each was duly elected by Members at the meeting:

- President – Gordon Lynas
- Secretary – Julie Lee
- Treasurer – John Sherman
- Membership Secretary – Christine Lyttle
- Social Secretary – Bruce Ewan
- Club Registrar – Patrick Quinn
- Editor – Patrick Quinn
- Public Officer – Alan Mitchell
- Regalia Officer – Colin Rule
- Webmaster – Jim Phillips
- Public Relations Officer – Ross Penman

Nominations were taken from the floor for the following roles, and each was duly elected by members at the meeting:

- Vice President – Jim Phillips
- Historian – Joe Armour
- Technical Officer – Greg Strange

Colin handed the Chair back to the re-elected President, Gordon Lynas.

5. Invitation to Honorary Membership

The Chair referred to the constitutional requirement for honorary members to be approved by members each year.

RESOLVED that invitations to honorary membership be extended to Bob Cutler and Graham Healey.

There being no further business, the Chair closed the meeting at 8:45pm.

FOR SALE and WANTED

For Sale

CAMS approved roll cage
Half hard tonneau
Soft tonneau

Any reasonable offer considered
Tim Scarr 0412 360 436

FOR SALE and WANTED

Austin-Healey Sprite Mk1.

Ex-Member Keith Manwaring is on the lookout for a Bugeye Sprite. Happy to pay well for the right car. Keith may be contacted on 0422 892 479

BN2 or Six-cylinder LHD steering box and sideshift gearbox in any condition.
Please contact 0417 673 065

FOR SALE and WANTED



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Contact: Vince Cessario AHOC Member
info@platinumsmash.com.au
13 Wilham Street - Artarmon NSW 2054

You are probably a little late to put your hand up to attend, but if you drop Christine Lyttle an email to membership@austinhealeynsw.com.au you never know your luck.

Make your booking today, don't delay and miss out.



A two course menu will be served with drinks.

If you have any food intolerances or allergies, please advise in your reply email when advising your booking.

To secure your seat, please reply by return email christinelyttle@hotmail.com and deposit \$40 for each ticket into the club's bank account with the description "YOUR NAME Xmas".

Account details
BSB: 032 669
Account: 252564

We look forward to seeing you at the Party!

Bah Humbug



The editor's Bah Humbug contribution for Christmas this year.

It's a BJ8 and in case you are wondering it's not wired to positive earth with a single 50amp fuse.

Actually it's prepared for a Christmas parade in the US and powered from a 1000 watt inverter and a very large deep cycle.

Thank you to Gregg Ainsworth for allowing the use of this still photo from his YouTube video.

Can you believe the year has gone? It's almost the end of 2021 and even though we have not been able to catch up very much with events, the year has flown by!

I wish everyone a very safe and Happy Christmas and New Year!

The Christmas Party is on Thursday night in place of the general meeting at Strathfield Golf Club and it will be nice to be able to meet up with members face to face.

New members this month are Mark and Gab Bancroft from Robertson. Mark purchased my Austin-Healey 100 when I sold it in late 1990 and was a member for some time before he sold the car. We welcome Mark and Gab to the AHOC and hopefully we can hold an event in the Southern Highlands in 2022 as there are some great drives and cafes to enjoy and they will be able to attend.

Stewart Everitt has been accepted as an associate member as of 23 November. Stewart has purchased a BJ8, applied to join the AHOC and we are awaiting the documentation to be finalised and the membership will be upgraded to a full member once presented to the committee. We also welcome Stewart to the Club and hope to see you at an event in 2022.

Membership Report Christine Lyttle

0410 201 373

membership@austinhealeynsw.com.au



The next General Meeting will be at Strathfield Golf Club on Thursday 3 February 2022 and hopefully there will be no changes with Covid-19 rules with further lockdowns.

Remember, we can only have details correct about you, if you advise us and update them, so please let me know of your changes of phone numbers, email and home addresses to the email on the right. Also, you can change your address, email or any other detail online through the AHOC website at <https://www.austinhealeynsw.com.au/>

Keep safe and well!
Happy Healeying
Christine Lyttle

Webmaster's Report

by Jim Phillips



Austin Healey Owners Club (NSW) Inc



Watch out for the changes that are soon coming to our website that will let you know about upcoming events. Our social secretary, Bruce Ewan, is busily planning the social calendar for 2022, now that perhaps we are going to be able to get out and socialise. These will be listed on the website and you will be able to record them in your calendar.

In the next version of the website there will be a separate tab that will enable you to see what's happening very easily without having to navigate different pages. You will also be able to print out the calendar and stick it on the fridge (does anyone still do that?) as a reminder. Also with the new Events listing you will be able to RSVP with 'yes',

Webmaster's Report cont'

'no' or 'maybe' so that we know who to expect. This will save the event organiser chasing around to see who's coming.

This addition is currently being tested and I'll let you know when all of this is on our website or better still regularly check on the website and let me know

when the developer has made the changes. Just look for the Events tab on the home page.

I would also like to thank those members that contact me about the website and wish all members best wishes for Christmas and 2022.

Social Report

Bruce Ewan 0432 096 493

social@austinhealeynsw.com.au

With much of 2021 now behind us and the Christmas Party this week, planning is now well underway for 2022.

With the volume of events, the number of people attending and the current environment, a new way of registering for events was urgently required. Thankfully our webmaster Jim Phillips and other Committee members are working on adding new elements to the AHOC website that will allow people to confirm for events and highlight upcoming events with greater clarity.

We have a raft of really interesting social activities that covers all manner of interests from rallies and car runs through to historic properties, inspirational gardens, art, and then the technical events.

February

6-19 February - Tassie Tour Led by Terry Bancroft

27 February - Trophy Presentation Day hosted by Philip Bloom (Belrose)

March

13 March – Workshop - Paint correction hosted by Vince Cessario (Artarmon)

28 March - Retford Park House & Garden Tour (Southern Highlands)

April

10 April – Workshop - Concours preparation and detailing led by Patrick Quinn and hosted by Terry Bancroft (Llandilo)

24 April - TBA

May

8 May - Mechanical workshop hosted by Greg Strange (Darlington)

10-13 May - Victorian mini Rally

16 May – National Motoring Heritage Day (TBA)

June

12 June – Workshop - Restoration and refurbishment hosted by John Sherman (Newport)

25 June – Abercrombie House (Bathurst)

For further details on each event including address, please visit the website at <https://www.austin-healeynsw.com.au/>. Details will be added to the website as the new functionality becomes available.

If you have suggestions for social events please send me an email to the above address.

Looking forward to catching up with members at the Christmas Party or in the new year.

Until then, cheers.

If interested, the Vaucluse Car Club are holding an event this coming Sunday 5th December. Have a look at <https://www.vauclusecarclub.com/>





Historic Vehicle Registration News

If you have a car on Historic Vehicle Registration you should read this.

After a busy few months, November saw activity slow a little. I can only assume that the closer we get to the festive season, there have fewer cars over time placed on Historic Vehicle Registration. However there have been three new members during the month who have had their vehicles conditionally registered.

One paid a pretty penny for a freshly restored BJ8 who then went and organised a personalised number plate, which was all well and good. Then in conversation we worked out what it was going to cost to fully register his car including stamp duty. He soon changed his mind as the initial cost of under \$100 was a little less than the thousands he would have paid.

There are a couple of things to remember with Historic Vehicle Registration. Firstly the vehicles are not exempt from the annual roadworthy inspection. Either a pink slip or our own inspection officers, Your choice. Secondly, the timeframe you have to renew the registration. Transport for NSW will post the renewal to you around four weeks prior to the renewal date which is plenty of time to organise an inspection, send in your paperwork and for it to come back to you. So many people leave it to the last minute and send in a note asking for it all to be done urgently.

As said last month from the start to the end of renewal period you actually have four months which is plenty of time.

Again talking about renewals, I still wonder how many members read these words as over the last month I continued to receive enquiries on the steps necessary to reregister a vehicle. Again here are the steps when renewing your Historic Vehicle Registration:-

- Once you have received the renewal from Transport for NSW, arrange for your vehicle to be inspected for roadworthiness by either an Authorised Inspection Station or one of the volunteer AHOC inspection officers. See page 2 of *Flat Chat* for their contact details. Remember all vehicles including Historic vehicles need to be inspected and passed as roadworthy.
- Complete the left hand side of the "Historic Vehicle Declaration" and post it to me at my home address (See page 2 of *Flat Chat* for my address) along with an indication that your car is roadworthy or a copy of the pink slip. Please include a stamped self-addressed envelope. There is no need to send me the registration certificate. Do not post me the documents by Registered Post as that just slows down the process as I have to go to the post office to accept a registered postal item.
- Once returned, either go to your local Services NSW office to do the renewal or post to Transport for NSW in Parkes. That address can be found on the registration papers.

Gregory Strange Motor Mechanic



Between Abercrombie Street & City Road

117 Cleveland Street,
Chippendale NSW 2008
Tel: 9319 2299
Mobile: 0412 811 958
MVRL 35580

November Central Coast Workshop

By Col & Kerrie Rule. Photos by Julie Lee.

We had a very good rollup at the November workshop morning with 17 Healey enthusiasts in attendance with eight Austin-Healeys on display.

The morning was productive with a windscreen fitting demonstration by yours truly on a BJ8 belonging to Amer Khoury. The second job tackled was the riveting of tags to a six-cylinder tappet cover belonging to Neil Janes.

This was done and dusted by 11 a.m. which gave us time for a very well deserved and mouth-watering morning tea with lots of cookies and cake.

The attendees were Neil Janes, Doug Ross BJ7, Jim Phillips 100/6, Louise Hicken BN1, Ian and Jenni Richter BJ7, Harley Boggis, John and Kay Wakeling

Datsun 240Z, Julie and Gary Lee BJ8, John Moses BN1 100, Amer Khoury and brother Nagg, John Matts, Col and Kerrie Rule BN1 and the Ross Bond 3000.

The next Austin-Healey workshop will be our Christmas gathering on 4th December. We will have a Show and Shine for cars with morning tea and a barbecue lunch. (BYO).

Don't forget your library books for exchange. The next Central Coast workshop will be Saturday the 5th of February and all members are welcome to attend.

So on behalf of Kerrie and me, we wish everybody a very Blessed Christmas and a safe 2022.



Engine Rebuild Finish - Part 4

by Neil Janes

I'm sure you have all been waiting anxiously to see how my engine rebuild has been going. Well, it's going well. In fact, as of today, I can say that it is finished!

The headers arrived from The Healey Factory very promptly and were installed without too much hassle (according to Steve the mechanic). The old exhaust system was in need of replacing so a sports muffler with side exit pipes has also been put into place. The rest of the important bits inside the engine bay have also been installed, tested and tuned.

The interior trim, transmission cover, carpet and seats have all been put back in place and look good as new.

I did note that on the first drive that I had no indicators, wipers or overdrive. Finding the blown fuse was simple (there are only two to choose from), however the reason for the blown fuse was not obvious. Replacing the fuse helped until I took it for another drive and the fuse blew again. After some trial and error, and several more fuses, I was able



to narrow the cause down to the brake light circuit. Each time I put my foot on the brake the fuse blew. An inspection of all the exposed wiring harnesses failed to provide an obvious cause so I removed the wire from one side of the brake light pressure switch (accessible from under the car) and found that I could drive it without blowing the fuse. Obviously, I had to drive without brake lights until I could get the problem diagnosed and cured.

An appointment was made to see Mark, a mate of Col Rule, a semi-retired auto electrician, and all-round nice guy. Within an hour he had determined that the metal lid on the complicated little brake light/indicator relay was shorting on the internal components. It seems that the newly replaced cold air ducting that runs just above the relay was applying enough pressure to the top of the casing that it was arcing internally. A bit of a shove and the problem was sorted.

You might also recall that the heater hoses were hard and required replacing. I thought this would require dropping the heater box from under the dash, however I was very relieved to discover that with enough contortion, sweat and perseverance both hoses could be replaced without dropping the box. It is not a job I want to repeat any time soon! It is however, the only part of the whole project that has turned out to be easier than I expected. A pleasant surprise!



Engine con't

So, it is all done - that is except for taking it back to the mechanic for a tweak after its initial 500 mile shake-down. It's noticeably more powerful than it was before the rebuild started. It has a higher performance camshaft, headers, balanced flywheel and crankshaft and a whole bunch of new internal components so I would have been disappointed if it was not. For the first 500 miles I am keeping it at or below 3,000rpm, but after that I will be able to see just how much better it pulls. Reconditioned shock

absorbers and new suspension bushes also helps it steer better than it did.

You might remember that this whole engine rebuild began because of a significant oil leak. After 11 months and many thousands of dollars it still leaks oil! Hopefully it is an easy problem to resolve when it goes back to Steve the mechanic for its initial check-up. I just plan to enjoy driving it for a while.



Tasmania Tour - 2022

This has been in *Flat Chat* for way over a year and if you haven't seen it before and are interested you are probably far too late to put your hand up. However if you just had a rush of blood to your head and want to go please contact Terry Bancroft on 0409 323 133, or (02) 4777 4883 or bangers@bancroft.id.au

You may pull out up to around December 2021 with nil loss.

This will definitely be the last Tasmania Tour that Pat and I will be organising.

Itinerary

February 6th -	Departing Melbourne on the Spirit of Tasmania
February 7th -	Breakfast at the Edgewater Hotel Devonport
February 7th & 8th -	Overnight stay in Burnie
February 9th & 10th -	Overnight at the West Coaster Motel Queenstown
February 11th-14th -	Overnight at the Old Wool Store, Hobart
February 15th & 16th -	Overnight Bicheno
February 17th & 18th -	Overnight Casino Launceston
February 19th -	Depart Devonport for Melbourne on the Spirit of Tasmania

All mornings will include either a continental or a full breakfast depending on where we are.

Meander cont'

The Josephs, Goldsmiths and Kellys joined with us for dinner that evening. Jugiong Motor Inn is a fairly basic motel, but has everything one needs and has comfy beds, and a lovely, grassed foregathering area which we might use on a future run. This time it was a little cool, so we retired to the bar before having a tasty dinner upstairs in the restaurant. If you are travelling along the Hume Hwy and need a place to stop between Albury and Yass we can recommend the Jugiong Motor Inn!

Saturday dawned clear and sunny and off we went to Corowa, being careful to avoid the Victorian border as we still thought ourselves 'personae non-grata' in that State. However, at Corowa we learnt how to get a permit to enter Victoria. Once you know how, it is really easy. The Victorian Covid app is much simpler and quicker to use than the NSW version as it just deals with Covid check-ins, permits and certificates.

Dinner that night was at the Corowa Golf Club travelling via its courtesy bus - an excellent initiative by Ray Hick which saved any of us having to drive anywhere.

Being the first Sunday of the month it was market day in Corowa. There was a good variety of stalls, and more than one hat was sold to an AHOC member. There was also a miniature railway running around a figure of eight hauled, rather surprisingly for such a small venue, by a live steam engine. Some of us spent a little while admiring the loco' whilst others inspected the wares for sale.



Corowa's live steam engine



The Johns, Fitzpatrick, Sherman, Hick, Lynas and Joseph cars at Corowa as Larry Johns and John Sherman chat, Lynn Fitzpatrick takes photos and Russell and Carole Kelly and Colin Goldsmith look on.



The masked shoppers at Corowa Market: Carole Kelly, Judy and John Sherman with Louise Lynas.

From Corowa to Moama was a sunny uneventful drive through Victoria now we had confidence in our ability to get permits. Of course, no-one ever asked to see any of our permits, but if they did, we were prepared. At Moama we had a small scare as some of our number received a Covid warning on their phones. There had been a Covid positive individual at the Corowa Market and we were thus all potential 'casual contacts'. Thankfully, when we checked the timing, we all had left the marketplace some minutes before the disease was reported to have arrived. (Phew! No quarantining necessary!)

Moama is the NSW sister town to Echuca which we had visited not so long ago, so we knew where to go for food, museums and the like. Our motel had a lovely garden courtyard at its centre with a pool and adjacent grassy area replete with plenty of chairs and tables. It was just perfect for a pre-prandial glass of beer or wine or whatever. Louise suggested we just stay there and get some pizzas delivered for dinner, which we did and had a very relaxed convivial evening enjoying the warmth of the afternoon and early evening sun while munching delicious pasta or pizza stacked with topping. There must have been a prawn bonanza somewhere as the pizzas were covered in them irrespective of what flavour had been ordered. A little red wine helped to wash the pizzas down and helped the conviviality.

Meander cont'



Chris and Lynn Fitzpatrick, Marita Joseph, Judy and John Sherman, and Helen Johns enjoying pizza and red wine at Moama.

Permits being easy to get, most of us travelled through Victoria, along the Murray to Swan Hill. I had booked all NSW motels just in case the dread C prevented us entering Victoria, so at Swan Hill we swung right crossed the Murray back into NSW and ambled out to the Murray Downs Golf Club and Resort where we gathered as is traditional on Charley's Run for a noggin before dining in the bistro that evening.

As this had been intended to just be a leisurely trip to Mildura for the Mini-Rally, we had been moving every day to a new town. The original plan was to get there and then relax for four days at the Rally. However, that was not to be. As I find moving on every day a bit tiring, I had booked a second night for us all at Swan Hill. Thus, we had a leisurely Wednesday enjoying its delights. Louise and I hadn't intended to visit the Pioneer Village, but we went there to buy tickets for that evening's 'Heart of the Murray' laser light show.

Once there we thought it looked interesting and so we entered. We were very impressed. It has been going since 1964 and over the years has acquired some amazing buildings including amongst many others, a Masonic Hall, a parish church, a mud brick kitchen, a half-cellar, all with appropriate interior decor and furnishings. There are also lots of farm machinery, a few traction engines, some old cars and two fire engines, as well as two paddle steamers. One of those was still active and several of our number went for an afternoon cruise. The other is permanently moored in a lagoon as a museum exhibit.

The light show began at 9pm with a laser light display taking us back in time "Dr Who" style, to tell the story of the Murray River over the millennia to today via the dreamtime and the commercial exploitation of the river for transport. It was interesting, informative, and at times spectacular, so well worth the visit.

From Saturday to Wednesday, we had travelled in sunshine and enjoyed warmish days and cool nights - just perfect for touring in Austin-Healeys. Thursday however, dawned grey, breezy, and bleak. Optimistically I had ventured out of doors in my customary holiday shorts, polo shirt and sandals only to quickly return to change into long pants, hoody, socks and shoes. At least the forecast rain mostly held off on the drive to Narrandera. The sombre weather did have the advantage that wild life was still out and about as we travelled. At Koondrook where we crossed the Murray, we were surprised to see a very large grey kangaroo bound across our path. It almost looked like it had been breakfasting in town.

After our late breakfast at the Deniliquin Bakery, we headed north once more and into frequent little showers of rain - Just enough to be a bit dispiriting, but not enough to force the roof to be raised. The trip was brightened by the variety of bird life we encountered, including a largish flock of emus grazing a paddock by the road. By the time we reached Narrandera, we were once more travelling in sunshine and ended the afternoon gathered together with the other Meanderers for a glass of wine and nibbles before dinner at the Lazy Lizard restaurant attached to the Motel, and so another day slipped past enjoyably.

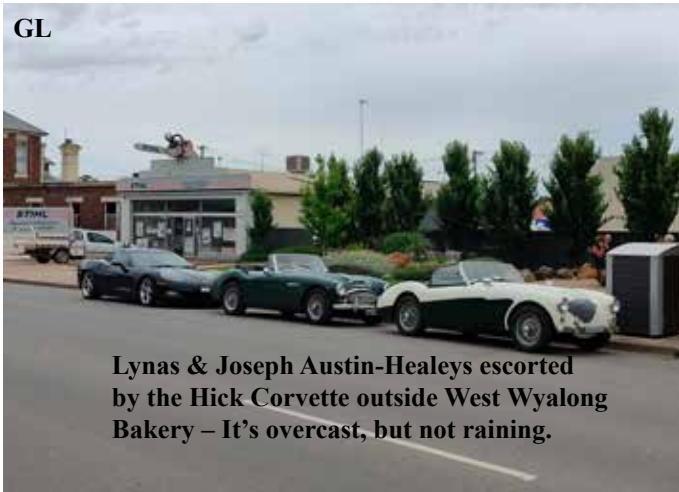
We awoke on Thursday to no less than five warnings of severe weather, storms, and extensive flooding! Not a happy sight when travelling in an open car.



Meander cont'

There were two areas of concern, and one of those sat right across our path from Narrandera to Parkes, the other looked likely to impact our northern contingent on their way home from Parkes.

GL



Lynas & Joseph Austin-Healeys escorted by the Hick Corvette outside West Wyalong Bakery – It's overcast, but not raining.

Luckily, the forecast horrors didn't eventuate for us, just a few showers marred the day, however, and we hadn't been at Parkes for long before the rain became more consistent and the showers heavier. That dissuaded those in open cars from venturing into town. The tin-toppers however suffered no such limitations and set out to inspect the neighbourhood, before returning as usual for a sociable drink and nibbles before the final dinner of the Mildura Meander.

We had originally intended to reach Mildura, but that aim had been halted at Swan Hill by the 'C'. Whilst we might have missed Mildura, we had all had a very enjoyable Meander!

GL



Must have been a good joke! Gordon and Louise Lynas, Fay Bryant, Marita and Adrian Joseph, Ray Hick and Colin Goldsmith enjoy a laugh together at Parkes.

NOTE

(The AHOC Vic Mini-Rally has been rescheduled until next May, so maybe we will finally get to Mildura?)

LF



LF



LF



LF



Rear Indicators

by Gordon Lynas

Back in 1968 I was driving in town when the Riley Pathfinder in front of me pulled into the left gutter. Its rear red lights were blinking on and off, sometimes left, sometimes right, sometimes both brake lights. As he was slowing and moving left, I assumed that he was going to park. Well that wasn't quite his intention, as I soon found out. I pulled out to overtake at which point he swung right to try and enter a driveway on the right side of the road. Needless to say the cars kissed wings rather abruptly bringing us both to an unexpected halt.

There was some damage to both cars' wings. Henrietta's (my 100) was a bit crumpled, but not so as to make the car un-driveable. The Riley had sprung the fibreglass repair from the rusty lower wing, but was otherwise just a bit scraped. We exchanged details and the other driver was adamant that he had been indicating a right turn. A witness confirmed that the front right hand blinker had indeed been blinking. I never found out the true cause of the random left and right blinking lights on the back of his car – maybe a wiring fault, or perhaps he had been pumping the brakes. Whatever the cause it had completely confused me, and that is how I had the only collision I've had in Henrietta.

Since that episode I have had a great distrust of rear indicators, like that fitted to Austin-Healeys where the turn indicator and the brake light are the same. So much so that I had the reflector mountings on my 100 modified to take an amber indicator light so that the car has separate turn and brake lights. This worked well, except that the people who did the conversion glued the glass lens onto the brass casting of the reflector mount. This had two drawbacks. One was that if one hit a pot hole a bit hard there was a good chance that one of the lenses would fall off. I learnt very quickly that while glass lenses look better, plastic ones do bounce and can be glued back in place.

Anyway, to get to the point of this diatribe, I decided that I would refit the lenses. I already had a couple of standard rubber tail light boots in my stores. They were old but still in reasonable condition, so I set to work.

The first task was to cut the lenses off the mountings without chipping paint or breaking either lens. Then I could unbolt the mountings from the rear shroud. Here is one showing the hole drilled in it to take the lamp socket and the amount of glue used to stick the lens on!



The holes weren't large enough to take the lamp holder and the rubber boot, so I cut the back off the boot to leave me with just the backing rubber and mouldings to hold the lens and chromed retaining ring. The diameter of that was too big, so I also trimmed off the moulding for the retaining ring, leaving just the rubber that would hold the lens.



Boot Before and after trimming



Indicators cont'

The standard lamp holder is designed to have the wires connected using bullet connectors. Here I discovered another hole that was too small. That was the one through the shroud through which the wires have to pass. Rather than enlarge that hole I simply soldered the wires onto the lamp holder.



I bolted the casting back onto the wing as that is the easiest way to hold it whilst drilling the holes. I found that a blunt knife made slipping the casting into the rubber mounting pad a simple task.



The lamp holder has three holes in the flange for self-tapping screws. It was a fairly simple matter to centre the holder on the mounting and drill three holes to take the screws. I used six gauge screws and found that a 2.9mm drill made just the tight sized hole. Here I have drilled two holes and screwed the lamp holder in place, using that as a guide to get the holes in the right place.



All that remained was to thread the wires through the mounting casting and through the shroud and



re-connect them to the wiring harness, then finish screwing the lamp holder and boot onto what had been the reflector mount and refit the globe and lens.

The finished installation is slightly larger than the reflector mounting, but that is not particularly obvious. (While the lens looks red in this photo it is in fact amber)

I suspect there are a few who will not approve of this



modification, but I feel safer with separate amber winkers. Having hit a few unavoidable potholes on the recent Mildura Meander, I can vouch that the modification holds the lens satisfactorily, and that I can now change a globe without needing a craft knife and a tube of glue.

Only in America would someone think you could cross an Austin-Healey with a 1959 Cadillac.

Who Will Save It?

It took me some time to recognise that this is a BN7



Photos of Interest



Three photos from the 1955 Liege-Rome-Liege Rally.



Top two show the 100S of the Belgian team of Franssen and Moineau. If you look closely at the first photo you will see that 100S was equipped with a full windscreen and soft top.

They retired during the Rally, the reason for which is not recorded.



The third photo is of the 100 driven by the Belgian/French team of Maquet and Gutenkauf who also retired during the event.



A wonderful period Austin-Healey promotional photo showing a LHD 3000 Mk2 Roadster and RHD Sprite Mk2. If you look closely, the photo has been remastered (before Photo-shop) so that the 3000 looks much smaller compared with the Sprite. Also look at how the shadows from both cars are cast in different directions.

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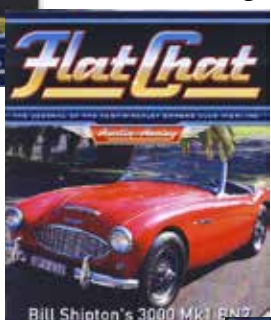
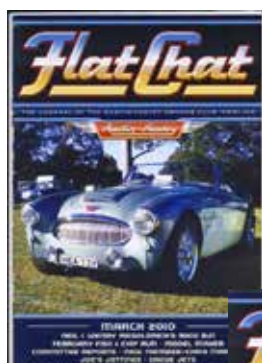
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stamp) at a meeting.





Gearbox Oil Change

Good to hear from South Coast member Bevan Cursley who writes that over a year back he had a local mechanic change the gearbox oil in his BN6. He wasn't sure what was put in, but it soon developed massive oil leaks from the gearbox.

Bevan didn't connect the oil change as the problem. Finally after 12 months of oil pooling on the floor he got in contact with Greg Snape from Harden Oil. He sent Bevan a specially formulated oil to try and

Bevan said that he found the results staggering with no more leaks, silky gear changes and perfect over drive.

Greg Snape is well known within the Historic Motorsport, especially with older vehicles and advised Bevan that the molecule size of modern oil is much smaller than oil for older vehicles and allows the oil to seep past the seals. Bevan sent the below for those interested.

TECHNICAL DATA SHEET

GEAR OIL CGE-30 SAE 30 GL-3

LUBEALLOY Classic Gear Oil GCE-30 is a proprietary blend of *HYDRO-SYN*[®] base oils and specifically engineered additives designed to deliver enhanced lubrication in classic manual transmissions, 'Wilson Pre-Selector' gearboxes and gearboxes utilising 'Laycock de Normanville' (commonly known as 'Electric') overdrives.

Description

LUBEALLOY Classic Gear Oil CGE-30 incorporates highly refined and thermally stable *HYDRO-SYN*[®] base oils, with specially selected supplements to provide increased load carrying capacity to protect gears, bushes and bearings against scuffing and wear during severe operating conditions of high temperature and load.

The stay-in-grade viscosity and advanced formulation chemistry provides excellent protection in both conventional and epicyclic gear trains, enhancing equipment reliability, performance and gear shifting characteristics.

GCE-30 incorporates a special foam suppressant and provides excellent frictional properties for a wide variety of friction materials utilised in many overdrives and 'pre-selector' transmissions.

Unlike many 'modern' gear oils, this unique combination of specially selected *HYDRO-SYN*[®] base oils and performance additives, maintains chemical and mechanical compatibility with 'old style' sealing technologies and gearbox designs, assisting to keep oil leakage to a minimum.

Application

LUBEALLOY Classic Gear Oil CGE-30 is ideal for use in many classic vehicles where the manufacturers originally specified SAE 30 oils for gearbox applications. During the 1950's and 1960's this specification was particularly common in British makes including Austin Healey, Jaguar and MG.

Specifications

API GL-1
API GL-2
API GL-3
VICKERS 35VQ25

Health and Safety: This product is not expected to cause health concerns when used for the intended application and according to the recommendations in the Material Safety Data Sheet (MSDS).

TDS.61833v20.GS/DG



Oxidation Stability

The advanced *HYDRO-SYN*[®] base oils and additive chemistry utilised in CGE-30 are completely compatible with copper, brass and bronze alloys, preventing oxidation of components such as bushes, thrust washers, synchromesh rings and bearing cages made of these metals and commonly found in classic gearboxes. Additionally, corrosion inhibitors effectively protect ferrous metals of gears, shafts and bearings from corrosion, even when vehicles are garaged for extended periods.

Product Benefits

- Stay-in-grade shear stability improving long term boundary protection
- Wear protection and cleanliness of all internal gearbox components
- High thermal temperature and oxidation durability and stability
- Lubrication, protection and maintaining elasticity of seals
- Improved oil fluidity in colder weather using *HYDRO-SYN*[™] base oils
- Enhances frictional characteristics of bands and clutches in pre-selectors and overdrives
- Improved gear shifting characteristics over conventional mineral oils
- Corrosion and oxidation protection of copper and brass alloys (yellow metals)
- Prevention of oil foaming

TEST DESCRIPTION	ASTM	TEST RESULT
Description	Visual	Clear/Amber
Viscosity Grade	SAE	30
Viscosity, cSt @ 40°C	D-445	87.5
Viscosity, cSt @ 100°C	D-445	11.2
Viscosity Index	D-2270	111
Density @ 15°C, kg/L	D-4052	0.874
Viscosity, Brookfield, cP @ -15°C	D-2196	5,374
Pour Point, °C	D-5950	-28
Flash Point (COC), °C	D-92	265
PRODUCT CODE		61833

Typical formulation specifications at time of production, minor variations may occur



The Challenges of Importing

By Patrick Quinn

Back in 1974 when I imported the Quinn Austin-Healey it was a simple and straightforward procedure. Sure in the pre-digital age you had to send the money by bank drafts and you planned your international phone calls, but apart from finding a forwarding agent to organise the shipping and a local customs agent, which was about it. I was even allowed to drive the car from the dock to another part of Sydney where it was pressure cleaned to remove unwanted nasties.

Fast forward to the mid-2000s when I brought two BJ8s in from the US it remained relatively the same, except that officialdom had appeared on the scene and after you have purchased your car you needed an Australian Government permit to import it. With a wonderful lack of logic, the government form stated - DO NOT SHIP YOUR VEHICLE UNTIL AFTER YOU HAVE RECEIVED YOUR IMPORT APPROVAL.

Also now in on the scene is the greedy hand of the tax office in the form of not only GST but the travesty known as Luxury Car Tax (LCT). So in addition to GST once the purchase price (including total shipping costs) passes \$68,740 (today's amount) you pay an additional 33 ½ %. Something I became intimately involved with when the Quinn Healey was shipped from the UK.

Forward again a few years and the Australian Border Force (ABF) has been formed and amongst other roles is charged with ensuring that no vehicle arrives in Australia with a skerrick of asbestos.

Fair enough it's reasonable that we don't want additional vehicles containing asbestos. However I don't know if new members Damien and Shena Carrick thought kindly about ABF when imported his BJ8 from the UK. It's interesting to note that Damien's car (HBJ8L/34151) was sold new in North America and was purchased there by Damien in 1989 and shipped it to the UK for restoration and conversion to RHD. When it was shipped to Australia, despite having owned it for 30 years the tax office still put up its hand for GST, but LCT was avoided. However he then came up against the officialdom of the ABF. Don't you just love all these abbreviations? Yes he had to have the car certified as asbestos free.

I'll let Damien take over from here.

The Australian authorities (ABF) are most emphatic that no trace of asbestos should be imported and are aware that some parts of older vehicles (and also some newer ones) may contain traces of it.

Doubtless we have all heard some horror stories of vehicles without evidence, being held for extended periods on the docks here, whilst ABF instructed mechanics to dismantle and inspect. An unhappy and expensive process and one best avoided!

I initially thought that as my vehicle had been fully restored with asbestos-free parts, then a certificate simply saying so, would suffice as proof thereof. Fortunately I was given sound advice to have a survey done prior to consignment and to present that with the documentation on arrival at the Australian port.

So, for anybody contemplating importation of a vehicle, I am recommending a similar plan.

There are professional surveyors available, but a reputable workshop or restoration company should be able to take the samples and prepare the report. If it is comprehensively and professionally done and, of course, shows a negative result, then that should be acceptable.

They (the ABF) will want to see in the report indicating evidence that samples were taken and sent for laboratory analysis. The laboratory should have National Association of Testing Authorities (NATA) accepted accreditation.

These samples should be taken from places where it would be expected that they would find asbestos.eg: Brake linings & pads, clutch plate & bellhousing, exhaust & gaskets, heat shielding, head gasket, floor matting and under carpet.

Basically, they expect to see between fifteen to twenty samples taken and sent to the lab. Photographic evidence is a good means to illustrate the origin of the samples and the bagging of them.

Text Cont' page 27. Asbestos report below.



Asbestos Report: Austin-Healey 3000 MkIII

Vehicle:	Austin Healey 3000 MkIII	Customer Name:	Damien Carrick
Registration No.	FAW426C	Date:	19/02/2021
Chassis/VIN No.	H-BJ8-L/34151	Address:	7 Salamander Quay
Engine No.	29K-RU-H/1952		Lower Teddington Road
			Hampton Wick
			KT1 4JB

This vehicle is Certified as "Asbestos Free"

This is a report of results from an inspection and sampling of the vehicle named above and pictured here.

It should be read in conjunction with the report from Envirochem Ref:J203256 FI:16

This vehicle has been fully rebuilt by us several years ago using new consumable materials throughout.

At that time it was converted to RHD.

The vehicle is currently MOT & Road Tax exempt and is fully roadworthy.



All accessible areas were assessed. These being: underbody areas, engine compartment, beneath carpets, behind instrument panel, boot and bonnet etc.

Any potentially suspicious components were sampled and sent for analysis by Envirochem, an independent laboratory that is UKAS accredited, (NATA equivalent under the MRA scheme). All returned a negative result.

Summary

Location	Inspection	Sample #	Lab Ref #	Asbestos test Result
Exhaust Swab	1	01	BS656614	No asbestos detected
Clutch Swab	2	02	BS656615	No asbestos detected
Oil Sump Gasket	3	03	BS656616	No asbestos detected
Diff Gasket	4	04	BS656617	No asbestos detected
Rear Brakes	5	05	BS656618	No asbestos detected
Exhaust & Firewall Heat Shield	6	06	BS656619	No asbestos detected
Front Brakes	7	07	BS656620	No asbestos detected
Boot Lining	8	08	BS656621	No asbestos detected
Rocker Cover Gasket	9	09	BS656622	No asbestos detected
Thermostat Gasket	10	10	BS656623	No asbestos detected
Exhaust Manifold Gasket	11	11	BS656624	No asbestos detected
Carb Gasket	12	12	BS656625	No asbestos detected
Under-Carpet (Sound) Insulation	13	13	BS656626	No asbestos detected
Under-Carpet (Heat) Insulation	14	14	BS656627	No asbestos detected

Cylinder Head Gasket	15	15	BS656628	No asbestos detected
Water Pump Gasket	16	16	BS656629	No asbestos detected
Complete Under-Car inspection	17			No asbestos suspected
Engine Bay Inspection	18			No asbestos suspected
Boot inspection	19			No asbestos suspected
Interior inspection	20			No asbestos suspected

Sampling process illustrations:

Exhaust Swab

Inspection No: 1

Sample No: #01

Lab Reference No: BS656614

Description: Swab sample taken from exhaust tailpipe

No Asbestos Detected in Sample



Clutch Swab

Inspection No: 2

Sample No: #02

Lab Reference No:
BS656615

Description: Swab sample taken of clutch bell-housing

No Asbestos Detected in Sample



Oil Sump Gasket

Inspection No: 3

Sample No: #03

Lab Reference No: BS656616

Description: Sample taken of gasket between Oil sump and engine block

No Asbestos Detected in Sample



Diff Gasket

Inspection No: 4

Sample No: #04



Lab Reference No: BS656617

Description: Sample taken of rear differential gasket

No Asbestos Detected in Sample

Rear Brakes

Inspection No: 5

Sample No: #05

Lab Reference No: BS656618

Description: Sample taken of rear brake friction material

No Asbestos Detected in Sample



Exhaust & Firewall Heat Shield

Inspection No: 6

Sample No: #06

Lab Reference No: BS656619

Description: Samples taken of board-type, heat shield on engine bay firewall and between footwell floor and exhaust. This material has been replaced throughout.



No Asbestos Detected in Samples



Front Brakes

Inspection No: 7

Sample No: #07

Lab Reference No: BS656620

Description:

Sample taken of front brake friction materials

No Asbestos Detected in Sample



Boot Lining

Inspection No: 8

Sample No: #08

Lab Reference No: BS656621

Description: Sample taken of the Armacord material lining the rear luggage area

No Asbestos Detected in Sample



Rocker Cover Gasket

Inspection No: 9

Sample No: #09

Lab Reference No: BS656622

Description: Sample taken of the cork gasket material between the rocker cover and the cylinder head.

No Asbestos Detected in Sample



Thermostat Housing Gasket

Inspection No: 10

Sample No: #10

Lab Reference No: BS656623

Description: Sample taken of the gasket between the thermostat housing and the cylinder head

No Asbestos Detected in Sample



Exhaust Manifold Gasket

Inspection No: 11

Sample No: #11

Lab Reference No: BS656624

Description: Sample taken of exhaust manifold gasket

No Asbestos Detected in Sample



Inlet Manifold & Carburettor Gaskets

Inspection No: 12

Sample No: #12

Lab Reference No: BS656625

Description: Samples taken of inlet manifold & carburettor spacer gaskets

No Asbestos Detected in Samples



Under-carpet (sound) Insulation



Inspection No: 13

Sample No: #13

Lab Reference No: BS656626

Description: Sample taken of the fabric sound insulation under the carpet

No Asbestos Detected in Sample

Under-carpet (heat) Insulation

Inspection No: 14

Sample No: #14

Lab Reference No: BS656627

Description: Sample taken of the fiberglass & silicone heat insulation under the carpet

No Asbestos Detected in Sample



Cylinder Head Gasket

Inspection No: 15

Sample No: #15

Lab Reference No: BS656628

Description: Sample taken of cylinder head gasket

No Asbestos Detected in Sample





Luggage compartment (Boot) Inspection

Inspection No: 19

Description: General inspection of all areas of the boot, including battery, tools and spare tyre

No Asbestos Suspected



Interior Inspection

Inspection No: 20

Description: General inspection of all areas of the interior, including under dashboard, seats and carpets

No Asbestos Suspected



The report then marries the photos of samples with the results from the lab and comes to a final statement that the vehicle is "Asbestos Free".

Any reputable shipping agent should already be aware of this and be pleased that you include such a report in your documentation.

Thankfully with Damien's extra care, his 3000 landed in Australia without difficulty, and has since been registered as a Historic Vehicle.

Yes there was another hurdle in registering the vehicle as it was originally built in LHD and its conversion to RHD needed to be certified beforehand. However that's a story best left for another time.

For the preceding seven pages is part of the asbestos report prepared in the UK for Damien and presented to the ABF before he was allowed to take his car home with



Damien & Shena Carrick's BJ8 in familiar surroundings

Thank you to Rick Neville in the US for sending the below.



The almost Healey-DeLorean connection

Rick Neville
Rowley, Massachusetts
Austin-Healey Club of New England

It's 1983. Your Jensen Healey is getting rusty and it's time for a new car. You traded your BJ8 in on the JH, and before that you ran a BJ7. You've always been a Healey loyalist, so naturally, you make the old JH look as good as possible, jump in, and head down to the local Healey dealer ready to trade up for the latest model.

There, you have quite a bit of choice. You quickly pass over the Healey 2000. A nice enough 2-liter two-seater, but you were hoping for some more grunt. How about the Healey 3500? Now we're talking. 3.5 liters of V8 power in a two-seater convertible. That might do nicely.

But wait. What's this? The Healey Gullwing at the top of the range with a twin turbo-charged V6, clad in an alloy body. Tasty, indeed. There's even a sedan with four gull-winged doors with room for the kids.

Science fiction? Alternate reality? No, more like a real possibility that would have been the result had a scheme to rescue the DeLorean Motor Company from receivership come to fruition. Strange that this is a relatively unknown bit of Healey history, but to fully understand it, along with its delightful irony, we must travel back a bit further to the demise of the big Healey.

Austin-Healey was part of the British Motor Corporation along with MG and Cooper. They were joined by Jaguar and formed British Motor Holdings (BMH) in 1966. But things were not going well for Britain's largest motorcar company, and while in 1967 it achieved sales of £467 million, it managed to lose £3 million in the process ... the kind of loss you can't make up on volume.

Enter our first villain in this play of possible redemption, Donald Gresham Stokes, later to become Lord Stokes. Stokes was head of Leyland Motors, consisting of Triumph and Rover and when, in 1968, Prime Minister Harold Wilson forced the marriage of BMH with Leyland, Stokes was widely seen as favoring the old town team in his efforts to save the faltering British motor industry that was plagued by outdated factories spread across the nation, poor designs and a desultory workforce prone to strikes urged on by trade unionist Derek "Red Robbo" Robinson.



And so, Donald Healey was summoned to Stokes's office in Coventry and told his services would no longer be required to produce sports cars in the new British Leyland (BL) empire. "I don't think there is any value in names," Stokes said, and as if to make his position perfectly clear, Stokes later renamed the

Austin-Healey Sprite the Austin Sprite and cut off the payment of royalties for the use of the Healey name. Likewise, MG and Cooper were killed off, leaving the field free for the entrance of Stokes's Triumph TR7.



Barrie Wills, (left) chief executive of DeLorean during receivership, with Charles "Chuck" Bennington, formerly first managing director and chief executive DeLorean Motor Cars Limited.

DMH moved on to become chairman of Jensen Motors in 1970 and produced the Jensen Healey sports car in 1972. But initial engine problems with its Lotus 907 motor, poor build quality, labor issues and the 1973 oil crisis all led to disappointing sales and Jensen, itself, went into receivership in 1975. Donald Healey sought to purchase the Jensen assets from the receiver and opened negotiations, but it would have meant he had to raise £1.5 million. An attempt to obtain funding from the British Department of Trade & Industry was unsuccessful, and DMH was once again out of the sports car production game.

Enter Villain No. 2 in the guise of John Z. DeLorean, the brash, handsome and dynamic former head of Pontiac, who turned the staid old company around with its "Wide-Tracking" and youth-focused GTO.

Eventually, DeLorean rose to the vice-presidency of General Motors on his way to being president. But his management style, long sideburns, Italian suits and jet-setting ways were anathema to many of the traditionally buttoned-up GM execs,

and when the dust had cleared, DeLorean resigned, or more likely was fired.

With an ego the size of the six-foot hood of the 1969 Pontiac Grand Prix that he fought with GM to produce, DeLorean felt the world needed an ultimate sports car and there was no one on earth better to make it than him. However, without GM's backing he needed a source of funds and eventually persuaded the British government to provide some £136 million of public moneys in exchange for locating the DeLorean Motor Company factory in Dunmurry, Northern Ireland, in hopes the jobs offered there would help alleviate rampant unemployment in the area that was felt to stoke sectarian violence, widely known as "The Troubles."

Imagine how Donald Healey felt. He was a proud and patriotic Brit who not only fought for Britain on the battlefield but carried the flag during the "Export or Die" period by bringing money back into Britain via one of its most visible and iconic automobiles. And yet, here was the British government refusing to provide a relative pittance to help save a British company while handing out massive amounts of Pounds Sterling to a Yank with what was essentially a Yank company. To

add insult to injury, as Geoffrey Healey recalled, the two civil servants from the Department of Trade and Industry whom DMH met with for funding, couldn't be bothered to rise from



A clay model of the face-lifted TR7/8 that could have borne the Healey name.

their seats and shake his hand, despite his advancing age at the time. As can be expected, the whole experience left Donald bitter, and according to Geoffrey, it was a slight from which he never recovered.

The rise and fall of DeLorean are so well known as need not be recounted here, except perhaps to introduce the potential hero in the rebirth of the Healey name ... Barrie Wills. Wills was one of the first DeLorean employees, appointed as Director of Purchasing in October of 1978, and one of the last, serving as Chairman during receivership in 1982. As the DeLorean Motor Company ship was sinking, DeLorean himself was busy seeking funds to keep the company afloat, including allegedly entering into a cocaine deal with a confidential FBI informant.

While DeLorean was looking for money, Wills came up with an inventive plan to secure capital from the British government which was by now well and truly sick of the name "DeLorean." Wills's solution was to rebrand the DeLorean DMC-12 as a "Healey," improve its performance that had always been a weak point, and adding other cars to the lineup.

It was to go like this. DeLorean Motor Company would be renamed the Dunmurry Motor Company after the place of manufacture of the gullwing and which would conveniently allow the continued use of the "DMC" logo designed by American Phil Gibbons, who claimed it was his "15 minutes of fame." The new car would become the "Healey Gullwing" and be given a performance "boost" through turbocharging. The Triumph TR7 and TR8, recently dropped from production by BL, would also be brought into the family with the TR8 being called the Healey 3500 and the TR7 known as the Healey 2000.

Wills, along with two other DeLorean-connected associates formed what was known as the "UK Consortium" to carry out the plan. The first step was to obtain a license from BL to

build the TR7 and TR8, which would both be offered only as convertibles. That commitment was received, with the idea being the car would be restyled to remove the sloping side creases that designer Giorgetto Giugiaro was said to have exclaimed when circling the car at its introduction, "Good heavens, they've done it on both sides!" More styling changes would be made with new front and rear bumpers, revised bonnet intakes and different logos. The use of the names "Triumph" and "TR" would not be allowed by BL, which the Consortium had planned for by using "Healey" instead.

So, the next stop was Healey. With Donald now retired to Cornwall, Wills approached Geoffrey who was carrying on the family business as Healey Automobile Consultants. A visit was arranged with Geoffrey at his home in Barford, Warwickshire, where he lived with his wife, Margot. In an interview with Wills, he described to me a short, but pleasant visit in which Geoffrey readily agreed to the plan to name the new cars as Healeys, in exchange for a royalty payment for each car sold. Despite the shortness of the visit, Wills related that Margot "served a fine cup of tea and was very generous with the biscuits!"

Such a step would not go forward without DMH's approval, which came back through Geoffrey quite quickly. Consider the turnabout, here. Lord Stokes, a "dreadful man," according to Wills, basically killed off any idea of Healeys being produced by BL in favor of the TR7 while DeLorean sucked away government funds that could have been used to save Jensen to produce, as Geoffrey described it, "a half-baked, gull-wing car." And under this plan the vehicles of the Healey nemeses, the TR7 and TR8, were to bear a Healey badge.

The could-have-been Giugiaro-designed sedan, a gull-winged four-seater that could have become known as the Healey gullwing sedan.





Surprisingly, Wills said any trace of resentment that the Healeys may have felt towards Stokes and DeLorean never came up, which Wills opined may have been in part to the fact that by 1982 funds from the Healey brand had mostly dried up and Donald and Geoffrey saw an opportunity to reverse that position. I still find it hard to believe there wasn't a little *schadenfreude* at play in the Healey decision to back the scheme.

Make no mistake, this was far from being a rebirth of the Donald Healey Motor Company. It was merely a rebranding in order to get the bad taste of the DeLorean name out of the mouths of the British government and other potential UK investors. The cars wouldn't be engineered by Healeys and distribution would be carried out in the States, in a concession made to John DeLorean, by his old network with him at the head. European distribution was to be handled by Tozer, Kemsley and Millbourn, owners of the Jeep and Daihatsu franchises in the UK. The Healey 2000 would be for the home and European market, while the V8-equipped Healey 3500 was going to the U.S. According to Wills, "At the time, we had forgotten there was a prior Healey 'Gullwing' that Healey developed for Le Mans. (*The Healey SR -Ed.*) That would have provided an excellent PR-link had we succeeded with the rescue plan."

With buy-in from BL and the Healeys, all that remained was obtaining the UK government's approval to the receivers paying the fee to the bank that was making funding possible. Prime Minister Margaret Thatcher misunderstood the presentation made to her by the James Prior, Northern Ireland Secretary of State, believing the government was being asked

to provide all the money for the new project, to which she responded, "Tell the receivers to do their job... there will be no more money!"

While the UK Consortium was making its play to start Dunmurry Motor Company, John DeLorean was still trying to get money to take his company back from the receivers and, in his desperation, allegedly turned to the famous cocaine deal that had been set up by the FBI. Wills feels that Margaret Thatcher was well aware of the FBI sting and allowed DeLorean several extensions of his funding deadline in order to keep him on the hook for the FBI. When asked whether he felt the trashing of the Healey deal was part of setting up DeLorean, Wills believed it was more "'cock-up' than conspiracy due to her inability to listen to what Northern Ireland Secretary of State, James Prior MP, was attempting to tell her and her obsession with micromanagement." (The machinations of the various plans to save DMC were much more complicated than related here. For the whole story, read *John Z, the DeLorean and Me ... tales from an insider* by Barrie Wills.)

The final nail in the coffin was DeLorean's arrest on charges related to the cocaine conspiracy, for which he was eventually acquitted based on his defense that he had been entrapped by the government. DeLorean Motor Company was liquidated and thus ended what was probably the best chance for revival of the Healey name. If Dunmurry Motor Company had succeeded, maybe in time there would have been new designs more in keeping with the Healey vision, a possibility we will never know. **HM**